QUESTIONS AS NUMBERED ON OFFICIAL ELECTION BALLOT

(Art. XIII, Sec. 8 of the Rhode Island Constitution)

Questions 6-17 Amendments to the Tiverton Home Rule Charter (Resolution of the Tiverton Town Council adopted July 27, 2026)

QUESTION 6. ARTICLE IV TOWN COUNCIL
Section 401 Organization

Ballot Question: *Shall the Charter be amended to increase the term of Town Council members from two (2) years to four (4) years and further provide for staggered terms so that no more than four (4) members are eligible for re-election each election cycle commencing November 7, 2028?*

Reason for Change: In order to provide stability and continuity in the Town Council, a four-year council term is created along with staggered terms. A longer term is sought to provide those elected a meaningful opportunity to learn about the operation and structure of local government and provide continuity for better management and leadership.

Effect of Change: The proposed amendment would not take effect until the election of November 7, 2028. It would increase the current term of the Town Council from two (2) years to four (4) years and provide for staggered terms.

2026 PROPOSED CHARTER AMENDMENTS

ARTICLE IV. TOWN COUNCIL

Sec. 401. Organization.

The non-partisan Town Council shall consist of seven (7) members each of whom shall be elected at large at the regular biennial election in even numbered years to serve for a term of ~~two (2)~~four (4) years and until ~~his/her~~a successor is elected and qualified. The term of a Councilperson shall begin at the first regularly scheduled meeting of the Council following certification of the election by the Board of Canvassers. Four (4) members of the Council shall constitute a quorum and no more than (4) members shall be up for election at any one time to allow for staggered terms.

In order to implement a staggered terms, those candidates who receive the four highest vote total as of the election of November 7, 2028 will be awarded a four (4) year term. The remaining three (3) candidates will be awarded a (2) two year term until the next general election in which the successful candidates will receive a four (4) year term.

Effective Date: This Amendment will become effective upon approval of the voters on November 3, 2026, and if necessary, subsequent ratification by the General Assembly.

QUESTION 7. ARTICLE VI FINANCIAL SERVICES
Sections 602 through 606

Ballot Question: *Shall the Charter be amended to provide for the appointment of a Town Treasurer by the Town Administrator, subject to Town Council approval, for a period not to exceed (3) three years, and update the position's powers and duties?*

Reason for Change: Tiverton is only one of two Rhode Island communities that elects its Town Treasurer. As an elected position, the only qualification necessary to seek the office is that the person be 18 years of age and a resident of the Town for at least 30 days prior to the election. There is no guarantee that a person who may seek this elected office has the necessary financial skills to manage the Town's finances.

Effect of Change: The Town Treasurer will no longer be elected by the voters but will become an appointed position and serve as a department head who reports to the Town Administrator.

2026 PROPOSED CHARTER AMENDMENTS

ARTICLE VI. FINANCIAL SERVICES

Sec. 601. Composition.

Financial Services shall consist of the Town Treasurer, the Tax Collector, the Tax Assessor, and the Tax Assessment Board of Review.

Sec. 602. Town Treasurer.

Section 602 Appointment

The ~~non-partisan~~ Town Treasurer shall be appointed by the town administrator, subject to the approval of the town council, for an initial contract period not to exceed (3) years, by no less than (4) affirmative votes of the Town Council~~elected for a four (4) year term at general elections~~. The Town Treasurer will report to and be supervised by the Town Administrator while also reporting on all municipal financial matters to the Town Council when requested.

Section 602 Qualifications

The qualifications for appointment as Town Treasurer are a bachelor's degree with five (5) years of accounting or equivalent financial experience and any such other qualifications as determined by the Town Council pursuant to Section 409 (9) of this Charter.

Section 603: Duties and Responsibilities

~~(a) *Duties and Responsibilities.*~~ The Town Treasurer shall have all the powers, rights, and duties prescribed under the General Laws of the State of Rhode Island for Town Treasurers including, but not limited to:

1.) Assuring compliance with all applicable accounting standards and requirements.

2.) Monitoring the spending by all departments, boards and commissions of the Town to ensure that the budget approved and adopted pursuant to Article III is not exceeded.

3.) Overseeing the processing of the municipal payroll.

4.) Monitoring the Town's cash position to ensure required liquidity.

5.) Managing Town investments in accordance with applicable laws and regulations.

6.) Working with appropriate financial advisors and counsel to issue general and special obligation bonds for the Town and ensure that such debt is properly serviced.

7.) Participating in the preparation of the annual Town capital improvement plan.

8.) Serving as a trustee for the Tiverton Police Pension Plan.

9.) Preparing an annual department budget and non-property tax revenue estimates to be submitted in accordance with Section 301(b)(2) and (b)(5) of Article III of this Charter.

10.) Utilizing appropriate resources including outside professional expertise in serving as a financial advisor to the Town Council, Town Administrator, School Committee or any other department, board or commission of Town government when they are considering an expenditure or financial transaction exceeding $500,000.00. ~~Collective bargaining agreements and requests submitted to the Budget Committee are excluded from this provision.~~

11.) Providing advice and recommendations in the negotiations of all municipal collective bargaining agreements ~~the AFSCME contract~~.

12.) Releasing to the parties legally entitled to redeem the same, real estate conveyed to the Town by the Collector of Taxes, upon payment to the Town of taxes, penalties and expenses thereto, and selling other parcels on which the period of redemption has expired.

13.) Borrowing, if necessary, in the name and on the credit of the Town, such sums of money as may be required for transacting the obligations incurred by duly approved appropriations, such sums of money not to exceed, in the aggregate, the sum of $500,000.00, provided that Town Council approval is granted prior to said borrowing.

604: Transitional Language and Vacancy

If the position of Town Treasurer shall become vacant by resignation, illness, or death after the adoption and ratification of this Article, the (Administrator or Town Council)will have the ability to appoint a Town Treasurer in accordance with Section 602. Otherwise, the person elected and certified as Town Treasurer on November 5, 2024 shall serve the remainder of their elected term.

Current Section 603 Tax Collector, 604 Tax Accessor, and 605 Tax Assessment Board of Review and 606 Transition will be re-numbered is the appropriate sequence upon the adoption of the proposed changes to Section 602.

EFFECTIVE DATE: This Amendment shall become effective upon approval of the voters on November 3, 2026, and if necessary, subsequent ratification by the General Assembly.

QUESTION 8. ARTICLE VIII TOWN OFFICIALS AND OFFICES
Section 801 Town Clerk

Ballot Question: *Shall the Charter be amended to provide for the appointment of a Town Clerk by the Town Administrator, subject to Town Council approval, for a period not to exceed three (3) years?*

Reason for Change: The duties and responsibilities of a Town Clerk have become more specialized and detailed based on the complexities of local governance. By making the position appointed, the appointing authority can ensure that the person has the necessary qualifications, skills, experience, and temperament to perform the office's important functions. As an elected position, anyone who is at least 18 years of age and a resident of the Town for at least 30 days is now eligible to seek the office.

Effect of Change: The amendment would make the office of Town Clerk an appointed rather than an elected position within Town government.

2026 PROPOSED CHARTER AMENDMENTS

ARTICLE VIII. TOWN OFFICIALS AND OFFICES

Sec. 801. Town Clerk.

There shall be a ~~non-partisan~~ Town Clerk who shall be appointed by the town administrator, subject to the approval of the Town Council by no less than four (4) affirmative votes, ~~with the approval of by a majority vote of the town council~~ for an initial contract period not to exceed three (3) years. ~~elected at the general election for a two (2) year term pursuant to the provisions of State Law and this Charter.~~ The Town Clerk shall be the Clerk of the Town Council, Clerk of the Probate Court, Clerk of the Board of Canvassers, Clerk of the Municipal Court and the Recorder of Deeds.

(a) Duties and Responsibilities. It shall be the responsibility of the Town Clerk to make permanent record of all proceedings and certify by signature all actions of the aforesaid bodies, be custodian of the Town Seal and of official documents, contracts, and records of the town. In addition, the Town Clerk shall direct and supervise the recordings of deeds, mortgages, surveys, vital statistics, licenses, permits and other such records as shall by ordinance and law be required to be kept. The Town Clerk shall issue birth certificates, marriage licenses and such other licenses and permits as required by ordinance or law. ~~The Town Clerk shall submit his or her budget in accordance with Section 301(b)(2) of this Charter and perform all functions as set forth in Article III related to the Financial Town Referendum~~. The Town Clerk shall perform all other such duties as may be prescribed by this Charter or by law, and such additional powers and duties as assigned by the Town Administrator.~~.~~

(b) Deputy Town Clerk. There shall be a Deputy Town Clerk assigned in accordance with contractual agreements (if applicable) and approved by the Town Council. When the Town Clerk is not available, the Deputy Town Clerk shall perform all the duties of the office of Town Clerk.

(c) The holder of the office of Town Clerk as elected and qualified on November 3, 2026, shall serve out the term of office for which the person was elected. If during said term, the office of town clerk becomes vacant by resignation, illness, or death, the Town Council shall appoint a

town clerk to serve the ~~remainer~~ remainder of the elected term. Thereafter, the appointment may be made in accordance with Section 801 above.

EFFECTIVE DATE: This Amendment shall become effective upon approval of the voters on November 3, 2026, and if necessary, subsequent ratification by the General Assembly.

QUESTION 9. ARTICLE VIII TOWN OFFICIALS AND OFFICES
New Section 806

Ballot Question: *Shall the Charter be amended to require that there be a Town Planner whom shall be appointed by the Town Administrator, subject to Town Council approval, for an initial contract period not to exceed three (3) years?*

Reason for Change: Given the pressures of development, environmental concerns, and economic growth, making the Town Planner a charter required position will ensure that the Town has the necessary resources and oversight to help manage these important issues.

Effect of Change: As a Charter mandated position, adoption of the amendment will require that a person be appointed to ensure that the Town's development is managed and overseen by a professional planner with the necessary qualifications.

2026 PROPOSED CHARTER AMENDMENTS

ARTICLE VIII TOWN OFFICIALS AND OFFICES

New Section 806: Town Planner

There shall be a town planner who shall be appointed by the Town Administrator, subject to the approval of the Town Council, for an initial contract period not to exceed (3) three years. Renewal contract shall not exceed (3) years. The qualifications for appointment for town planner shall be determined by the Town Council pursuant to Section 407 (9) of this Charter.

(a) Duties and Responsibilities: The town planner shall work with and advise the Planning Board regarding land use policies and procedures, the implementation of state law and local regulations related to land development, economic growth and long-term planning related to land use, sustainability, and environmental protection. The Town Planner shall balance the needs of the community, environment, and local economy by reviewing proposals, analyzing data and trends, and making recommendations to the Planning Board in order to ensure functional, safe, and sustainable growth.

Effective Date: This section shall become effective upon approval of the voters on November 3, 2026, and, if necessary, subsequent ratification by the General Assembly.

QUESTION 10. ARTICLE II ELECTIONS
Section 204 Transfer of Land &
ARTICLE IV TOWN COUNCIL
Section 407 Powers and Duties

Ballot Question: *Shall the Charter be amended to authorize the Town Council to sell, transfer, or lease land except land owned by the Town for open space, recreation, or conservation purposes? Land owned by the Town for such purposes could only be sold or leased with the approval of electors of the Town at a regular or special election.*

Reason for Question: The current Charter language requires that any property rights or sale of land owned by the Town must be approved by the voters at a Financial Town Referendum (FTR), which no longer exists. The Town often obtains interests in land through tax sales, and those properties cannot be sold without FTR approval under the current Charter language.

Effect of Question:

The proposed amendments will clarify the authority of the Town Council to sell, transfer or lease land. In a practical sense, the amendments will provide the Town Council with the power to sell land acquired at tax sale or by other means without having to go through the process of voter approval prior to its sale or lease. Land held and owned by the town for open space, recreation, or conservation purposes could not be sold or leased without voter approval. This amendment is designed to allow the Town to sell land it acquires from tax sales and other means and return it to the tax base and eliminate the need for voter approval for such sales.

2026 PROPOSED CHARTER AMENDMENTS

ARTICLE II. ELECTIONS

Sec. 204. Transfer of Town Land.

The transfer of any property rights in and/or ownership of any parcel/lot or tract of land owned by the Town of Tiverton for open space, recreation, or conservation ~~as of November 5, 2008, except for parcels in the Industrial Park and transfers pursuant to G.L. § 44-9-18.3,~~ must be approved by a vote of the electors of the Town of Tiverton ~~either at a Financial Town Referendum, or a Referendum~~.at a regular or special election as determined by the town council. All material terms of such sale, lease, or transfer of property rights must be made known to the electors by publication on the Town's official website and any other manner as the Town Council may determine for at least twenty-one (21) days prior to the election. ~~Any such approval shall expire within five (5) years. Leasing of Town property for a period of ten (10) years or less shall not constitute a transfer of property, provided that at the end of the leasing period the Town retains sole right to renew, continue, or terminate the lease.~~ This section shall not prohibit the Town Council from transferring property rights for the purpose of restricting use of any parcel/lot of land, for conservation or preservation purposes, or in connection with the provision of public utilities or similar services.

ARTICLE IV TOWN COUNCIL

Section 407. Powers and Duties

[adding]:

17. To acquire, sell, transfer, or lease any real property subject to the limitations as set forth in Article II, Section 204.

Effective Date: This Amendment will become effective upon approval of the voters on November 3, 2026, and if necessary, subsequent ratification by the General Assembly.

QUESTION 11. ARTICLE VII BUDGET COMMITTEE
Section 701 through 703 &
ARTICLE III ANNUAL BUDGET PROCESS/FINANCIAL TOWN REFERENDUM
Section 301(b)(6)

Ballot Question: *Shall the Charter be amended to remove all references to a Budget Committee and its duties?*

Reason for Change: In 2022, voters approved a change to the budget creation and adoption process and made the Budget Committee an elected advisory committee to the Town Council. Since that approved change, persons have not sought to be elected to the Committee, and it has failed to meet due to a lack of a quorum. Therefore, the Budget Committee's role has become obsolete.

Effect of Change: The amendment will remove the Budget Committee as an elected body within the Town.

2026 PROPOSED CHARTER AMENDMENTS

ARTICLE VII BUDGET COMMITTEE

ARTICLE VII IS STRICKEN IN ITS ENTIRETY AND ARTICLE III, Section 301(b)(6.) is deleted as noted and the Section shall be marked **RESERVED** for future use.

~~ARTICLE VII. BUDGET COMMITTEE~~

~~Sec. 701. Composition.~~

~~The Budget Committee shall consist of (7) seven members elected for a term of four (4) years, so staggered, that no more than (4) four terms expire at any one time. The Budget Committee shall elect annually, from among its membership, a Chairperson, Vice Chairperson, Secretary, and other such officers as they deem appropriate. Budget Committee members shall hold no other elected or appointed office or position with town government or serve on any board or commission therein~~

~~Sec. 702. Elections and Vacancies~~

~~Any vacancies on the non-partisan Budget Committee shall be filled in the manner provided for in this Charter.~~

~~(a) Transitional Election. The first Budget Committee membership terms to expire after the adoption of this amendment shall be extended to the next general election, at which time a like number of candidates shall be elected. Provided, however, that any reduction in the number of persons to serve on the budget committee by a charter amendment shall become effective in the next general election following its adoption.~~

~~Sec. 703. Duties and Responsibilities.~~

~~The Budget Committee has the following responsibilities:~~

~~1.) To participate in the Initial Budget Workshop.~~

~~2.) To review the unified budget submitted by the Town Administrator , in which review the Committee shall consider both the supporting evidence for each requested budget expenditure and the ability of the Town to support the level of service recommended.~~

~~3.) To prepare and submit their proposed Unified Budget and any proposed language necessary to implement the budget in accordance with Article III, section 301(b)(6).~~

ARTICLE III ANNUAL BUDGET PROCESS/FINANCIAL TOWN REFERENDUM
Section 301. Budget Adoption Process

~~(b)(6.) Budget Committee: The budget committee shall prepare and submit to the town council their proposed Unified Budget and any proposed language necessary to implement the budget on or before April 25th~~ and the section marked RESERVED or the remaining sections be renumbered at the instruction of the Town Clerk/Solicitor.

Effective Date: This Amendment will become effective upon approval of the voters on November 3, 2026, and if necessary, subsequent ratification by the General Assembly.

QUESTION 12. ARTICLE X BOARDS AND COMMISSIONS
Section 1008 Tiverton Harbor and Coastal Waters Management Commission

Ballot Question: *Shall the Charter be amended to reduce the number of members of the Tiverton Harbor and Coastal Waters Management from nine (9) to seven (7) and eliminate the need from one of its members to also be a sitting member of the Planning Board?*

Reason for Change: The reduction in the number of members will allow the Commission to reduce its quorum to conduct business. The position allocated for the Planning Board has not been filled for a number of years. Removing the requirement will allow for the position to be filled by an active member.

Effect of Change: The Tiverton Harbor and Coastal Waters Management Commission will be reduced from nine (9) to seven (7) members and no longer require that one of its members also be a member of the Planning Board.

2026 PROPOSED CHARTER AMENDMENTS 2026

ARTICLE X: BOARDS AND COMMISSIONS

Sec. 1008. Tiverton Harbor and Coastal Waters Management Commission.
The Tiverton Harbor and Coastal Waters Management Commission (THCWMC) shall consist of ~~nine (9)~~seven (7) members appointed by the Town Council for two (2) year terms, staggered so that no more than ~~five (5)~~ four (4) terms expire in any one year. ~~The THCWMS shall include one member of the Planning Board~~. Preference shall be given to representation by the following special interests: Recreational boaters, recreational fishermen, commercial fishermen, riparian property owners, and conservationists. In the event of a vacancy the Town Council shall appoint a replacement from the same interest group for the duration of the unexpired term.

Effective Date: This Amendment will become effective upon approval of the voters on November 3, 2026, and if necessary, subsequent ratification by the General Assembly.

QUESTION 13. ARTICLE X BOARD AND COMMISSIONS
Section 1001 Planning Board

Ballot Question: *Shall the Charter be amended to reduce the membership on the Planning Board from nine (9) to seven (7) members with other clarifying amendments as to the Town Planner's role and to conform with state law?*

Reason for Change: Because of the large number of persons now necessary to be appointed to the Planning Board, it has been difficult to have a working quorum as well as recruit qualified persons who are willing to serve on it. Lowering the total number of members from nine (9) to seven (7) will reduce the quorum necessary to conduct business from five (5) to four (4).

Effect of Change: The amendment would reduce the number of members to be appointed to the Planning Board by the Town Council from nine (9) to seven (7).

2026 PROPOSED CHARTER AMENDMENTS

ARTICLE X. BOARDS AND COMMISSIONS

Sec. 1001. Planning Board.

(a) *Duties and Responsibilities.* The Planning Board shall have the duties and responsibilities provided for in State law and such additional duties and responsibilities as may be prescribed by the Town Council not in conflict with the State law. The Planning Board shall act in an advisory capacity to the Town Council in all matters concerning the Comprehensive Community Plan, land use, Zoning and Subdivision Regulations, physical growth and development of the Town. The Planning Board shall work with and be advised by the Town Planner on issues related to land use, physical growth and development.

(b) *Composition and Vacancies.* The Planning Board shall consist of ~~nine (9)~~seven (7) members appointed by the Town Council from among electors of the Town for a term of three (3) years. Said terms will be staggered so that no more than one-third (1/3) will expire in any given year. No member of the Planning Board shall be an elected official or employee of the Town. Any member of the Planning Board may be removed from office by the Council for due cause, following a public hearing. The Town Council shall appoint replacements to fill vacancies on the Board. The Board shall annually elect a Chairperson, vice-chairperson, secretary and such other officers as it may deem appropriate from among its membership.

Effective Date: This amendment will become effective upon the approval of the voters on November 3, 2026 and if necessary, subsequent ratification by the General Assembly.

QUESTION 14. ARTICLE X BOARD AND COMMISSIONS
Section 1007 Personnel Board

Ballot Question: *Shall the Charter be amended to clarify the role of the Town Council in the application review, selection of applicants, and interview process of potential appointees to the position of Town Administrator and to clarify that the Personnel Board has authority to interview applicants for all full and part-time positions?*

Reason for Change: Because the Town Council is the only body empowered to appoint the Town Administrator, the proposed amendment clarifies the role it and the Personnel Board have in the selection of the Town Administrator and clarifies the Personnel Board's authority to interview applicants.

Effect of Change: The amendment would clarify roles in the process of screening potential applicants for the position of Town Administrator.

2026 PROPOSED CHARTER AMENDMENTS

ARTICLE X BOARDS AND COMMISSIONS

Sec. 1007. Personnel Board.

The Personnel Board shall consist of five (5) electors appointed by the Town Council for four (4) year terms. Terms shall be staggered so that no more than two (2) terms expire in any year. Vacancies shall be filled by the Town Council for the remainder of the unexpired term. The Commission shall annually elect a Chairperson, Vice Chairperson, and such other officers as they deem appropriate.

(a) Duties and Responsibilities. The Personnel Board shall accept and review applications for all full and part-time job vacancies for town employment and recommend applicants to the Town Administrator. The Personnel Board may develop a method for advertising vacant municipal positions.

The Personnel Board shall:

1.) Review all applications for full and part-time employment

2.) Determine those applicants to be interviewed and interview the selected applicants.

3.) For those applicants to be interviewed, be responsible for verifying the accuracy of information on applications and checking references, including former or current employers.

4.) The Town Council is responsible for the hiring of the town administrator, and it shall review and approve the job description for the position prior to it being posted and advertised. All applications and submissions for the position of town administrator shall be sent to the personnel board for review, and if determined to be qualified by the

personnel board, to be interviewed. After the interviews are completed, the personnel board shall recommend to the town council applicant(s) for their further consideration.

Effective Date: This Amendment will become effective upon approval of the voters on November 3, 2026, and if necessary, subsequent ratification by the General Assembly.

QUESTION 15. ARTICLE X BOARD AND COMMISSIONS
Section 1002 Zoning Board

Ballot Question: *Shall the Charter provision related to the Zoning Board be amended to reflect changes in state law?*

Reason for Change: Because of changes in state law related to the powers and duties of the Zoning Board and the transfer of certain appeals from the Planning Board, the charter amendments are designed to conform the local charter language to those laws as well as clarify some of the existing language.

Effect of Change: The changes will ensure that the Charter language is consistent with the requirements of state law.

2026 PROPOSED CHARTER AMENDMENTS

ARTICLE X. BOARDS AND COMMISSIONS

Sec. 1002. Zoning Board of Review.

(a) Duties and Responsibilities: The Zoning Board of Review shall have such powers and duties as are prescribed by R.I.G.L. 45-24-57 as amended, ~~the Laws of the State~~, this Charter, and Town Ordinances. ~~Town Ordinance and this Charter.~~ The Zoning Board of Review shall also serve as the Board of Appeals from decisions of the Administrative Officer and shall have such ~~Planning Board of Review and shall have such~~ powers and duties as are prescribed by the Laws of the State, Town Ordinance and this Charter.

(b) ~~(a)~~ Composition and Vacancies. The Zoning Board of Review shall consist of five (5) members plus two (2) alternates appointed by the Town Council from among the electors of the Town. The alternates shall be designated as a 1st Alternate and a 2nd Alternate. Members shall be appointed~~,~~ for a term of five (5) years. Said terms shall be staggered so that no more than one (1) will expire in any given year. Alternate members shall be appointed for a term of one (1) year and may sit on the Board and actively participate in all matters before the Board, but shall only vote if they are filling in for a regular member who is absent and they have attended all hearings on the matter before them. ~~petition~~.

(c) No member or alternate member shall be an elected official or employee of the Town. Vacancies of regular members shall be filled by the first alternate and a replacement alternate member appointed by the Council. The Board shall annually elect a Chairperson and a Vice-Chairperson and such other officers as they deem appropriate~~.~~

(d) A member or alternate member of the Zoning Board may be removed from office by the Town Council for due cause, after a public hearing.

EFFECTIVE DATE: This Charter Amendment shall become effective upon the approval of the voters on November 3, 2026, and if necessary, subsequent ratification by the General Assembly.

QUESTION 16. ARTICLE X BOARD AND COMMISSIONS
Section 1014 Economic Development Commission

Ballot Question: *Shall the Charter be amended to update the duties and responsibilities of the Economic Development Commission and change outdated language?*

Reason for Change: The role and duties of the Commission needed to be updated to reflect changes in the economic environment with an emphasis on small business needs.

Effect of Change: The updated language will better reflect the goals and charge of the Commission.

2026 PROPOSED CHARTER AMENDMENTS 2026

ARTICLE X: BOARDS AND COMMISSIONS

Sec. 1014. Economic Development Commission.

The Economic Development Commission shall consist of five (5) members. All members shall be appointed by the Town Council. Members shall serve for four (4) year terms and the appointments shall be staggered so that no more than two (2) terms expire in any single year. Vacancies shall be filled by the Town Council for the remainder of the unexpired term. The Economic Development Commission shall annually elect a Chairperson and other officers, as it deems appropriate.

(a) *Duties and Responsibilities.* The Economic Development Commission shall report to the Town Administrator. The Economic Development Commission shall:

1.) Act as a liaison with the ~~RI Economic Development Corporatio~~ appropriate state economic development agencies and divisions ~~n~~ in order to affect state plans on the local level.

2.) Assist town businesses, particularly those that are marine or agriculture, related to tax relief and low cost loans or grants for business startup, expansions or expenses related to renovations.

~~3.) Assist businesses to access the benefits associated with the Enterprise Zone.~~

~~4.~~3.) Assist in ~~the search for and attraction of businesses, which would be consistent with the town's Comprehensive Plan.~~recruiting new businesses to the Town that will assist with the diversification of the tax base, contribute to the character of the town, and be consistent with the Community Comprehensive Plan.

4) Provide local business with resources and information about state programs and initiatives that are designed to assist local businesses.

5) Develop networking opportunities and supports with local businesses to encourage communication and common goals.,

6) Establish a public database of vacant industrial and commercial properties in the Town.

7). Work with the Town Planner to implement storefront and street scape improvement programs in commercial districts.

Effective Date: This Amendment will become effective upon approval of the voters on November 3, 2026, and if necessary, subsequent ratification by the General Assembly.

QUESTION 17. ARTICLE XI SCHOOL DEPARTMENT
Section 1101 School Committee

Ballot Question: *Shall the Charter be amended to clarify that the School Committee shall elect officers from its membership (i.e. chair and vice-chair) who shall serve at the pleasure of the School Committee?*

Reason for Change: The language clarifies that the officers of the Committee must be from its elected members and that the Chair and Vice-Chair serve at the pleasure of the majority of the Committee

Effect of Change: The updated language clarifies that the Chair and Vice Chair serve at the pleasure of the majority of the membership and are chosen from the elected members of the School Committee.

2026 PROPOSED CHARTER AMENDMENTS

ARTICLE XI: SCHOOL DEPARTMENT

Sec. 1101. School Committee.

There shall be a non-partisan School Committee consisting of five (5) members, elected "at-large" for four (4) year terms. Terms shall be staggered so that no more than three (3) expire every two (2) years. School Committee members shall be elected at the General Election in even numbered years. School Committee members shall be electors of the Town and shall not hold other elected town offices or be employees of the Town. Should a Committee member fail to meet the above qualifications, or become disqualified from continuing in office under the provisions of the State Constitution, State Law or this Charter, his/her office shall be deemed to have become vacant. The vacancy shall be filled in the manner provided in the provisions of this Charter. The School Committee shall ~~annually~~ elect from its members a Chairperson, Vice Chairperson, and such other officers as they deem appropriate, each of whom shall serve at the pleasure of the committee~~.~~ Copies of the minutes of School Committee meetings shall be on file in the office of the Town Clerk.

Effective Date: This Charter Amendment shall become effective upon the approval of the voters on November 3, 2026, and if necessary, subsequent ratification by the General Assembly.